

Americas Energy & Transition

Exxon Mobil Corp

Rating

Outperform

Price Target

 XOM

182.00 USD



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Americas Oil: Ignore the facts in front of you...the crack-implied oil price is >\$90/bbl

Oil is useless for the most part. As a product, it has little utility in its raw state. However, oil is not worthless. It has a **price which today sits below \$70/bbl** (up perhaps 20% from the start of the year). When oil is refined into useful products, it drives the global economy. The two largest uses for global transport are gasoline and diesel purchased by consumers. Those prices are up >50% from the start of the year.

We have never witnessed a greater disconnect between today's oil "input" price and the refined products "output" price (Exhibit 1). We use the crack spread to describe that difference. Traditionally a 3-2-1 crack spread based on Nymex contracts - the normalized per-barrel difference between the revenue from 2 barrels of gasoline and a barrel of diesel subtracting the input cost of crude (WTI).

We show that **average crack spreads are "predictable"** (Exhibit 2). For decades, the typical crack spread was 20% of oil price. In the last decade plus, the typical crack spread has been 33% of oil price.

Given the predictability, **we can back-solve for oil price using just gasoline and diesel prices. The model fits well** (Exhibit 3).

We zoom in to show the post 2020 era (Exhibit 4). The Russia-Ukraine war disrupted transport and supply chains, increasing crack spreads (and thus refiner's profitability) and thus the error term (misfit) of the model rose. Today's result (Exhibit 5) is at a **record disconnect - spot prices trading below \$70/bbl while crack-implied price is \$20+/- bbl higher at \$90+/-bbl**.

Close Date	6 Jul 2026
XOM Close Price (USD)	136.44
Price Target (USD)	182.00
Upside/(Downside)	33%
52-Week Range	176.41/105.53
SPX	7,503.85
FYE	Dec
Div Yield	2.9%
Market Cap (USD) (M)	579,188
EV (USD) (M)	625,029
Performance	YTD 1M 6M 12M
Absolute (%)	16.1 (6.8) 17.9 25.8
SPX (%)	9.6 1.6 8.4 20.4
Relative (%)	6.5 (8.4) 9.5 5.3

Source: Bloomberg, Bernstein estimates and analysis.

Price Performance, 1YR

Adjusted EPS	F25A	F26E	F27E
XOM (USD)	7.37	16.37	14.49

Financials	F25A	F26E	F27E	CAGR
EBITDA (M)	63,948	108,033	96,410	22.8%
CFO (M)	51,970	78,969	94,585	34.9%
CapEx (M)	28,358	27,330	28,461	0.2%
FCF (M)	26,043	59,045	73,530	68.0%

Valuation Metrics	F25A	F26E	F27E
Adjusted P/E (x)	18.5	8.3	9.4
EV/EBITDA (x)	9.8	5.8	6.5
EV/FCF (x)	24.0	10.6	8.5

Source: Bloomberg, Bernstein estimates and analysis.

See the Disclosure Appendix of this report for required disclosures, analyst certifications and other important information. Alternatively, visit our [Global Research Disclosure Website](#).

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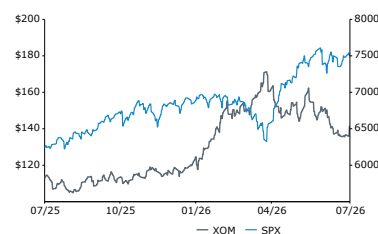
While disrupted supply chains can explain part of today's disconnect, the more important **distortion is the release of government strategic reserves distorting commercial inventories** (Exhibit 6) plus perhaps some ability of the Trump administration to verbally and visibly talk down prices.

Some implications. (1) We continue to be comfortable in a mid-cycle price of oil of \$75/bbl Brent (\$72/bbl WTI). (2) \$90/bbl implied oil price should not be sufficient to destroy demand and thus can continue. (3) the Strait is barely re-opened and may not stay open so risks are to upside. (4) refiners (and integrators with refining businesses) will generate significant excess returns from the disconnect between oil and crack-implied oil. (5) crack spreads (refining margins) can remain elevated for years after supply shocks (e.g., Russia-Ukraine). (6) The ability of governments to physically (i.e., SPR releases) or verbally (i.e., communications) push down crude oil price need not be permanent. (7) The desire for governments to eventually rebuild strategic inventories can likely generate an SPR put somewhere in the \$60s/bbl (near where we are now). The scale of the rebuild could measure in hundreds of thousands of barrels per year (a significant percentage of expected demand growth) and could last for years.

Despite a historically poor time for entry (mid year) and despite a reasonably balanced market in the outyears, we still believe **now is a good time** for integrated oil exposure (XOM our top choice) and even E&P exposure (DVN and FANG have the most upside in our coverage).

Investment Implications

We think integrators will benefit from this disconnect from cracks and oil price with a preference for XOM. For E&Ps, we prefer FANG and DVN.

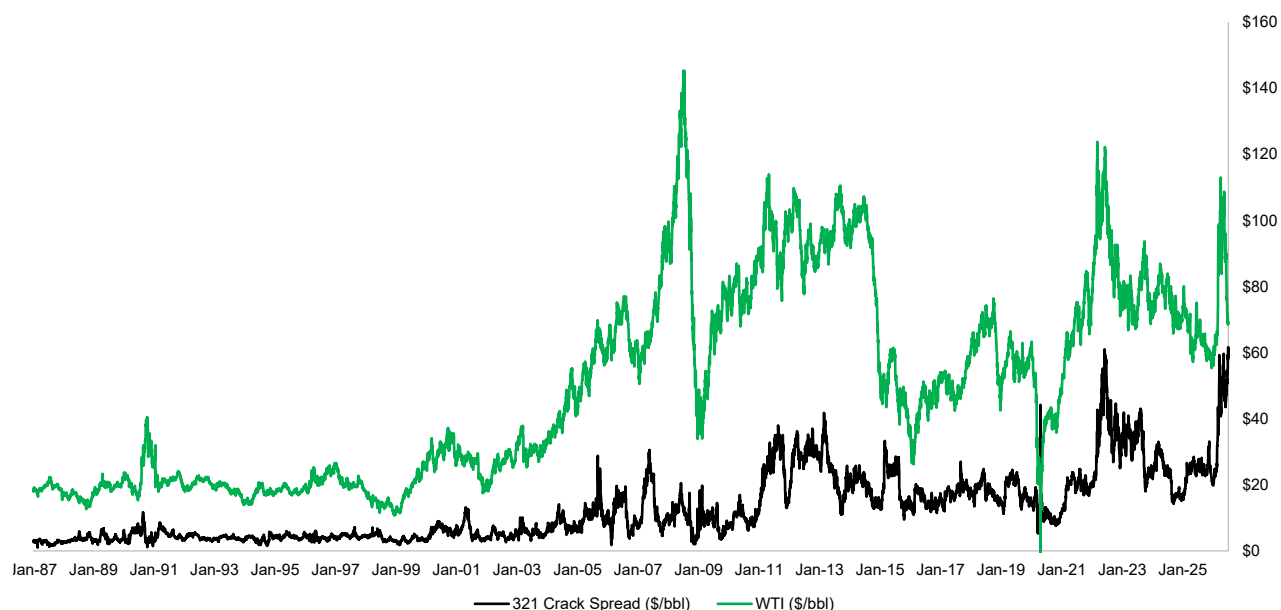


DETAILS

We remind investors that oil price and crack spreads vary over time (WTI futures only started trading in March of 1983 and other products later). Today's crack spreads remain near record levels while oil prices have pulled back remarkably.

A 3-2-1 crack spread based on Nymex contracts - the normalized per-barrel difference between the revenue from 2 barrels of gasoline and a barrel of diesel subtracting the input cost of crude (WTI).

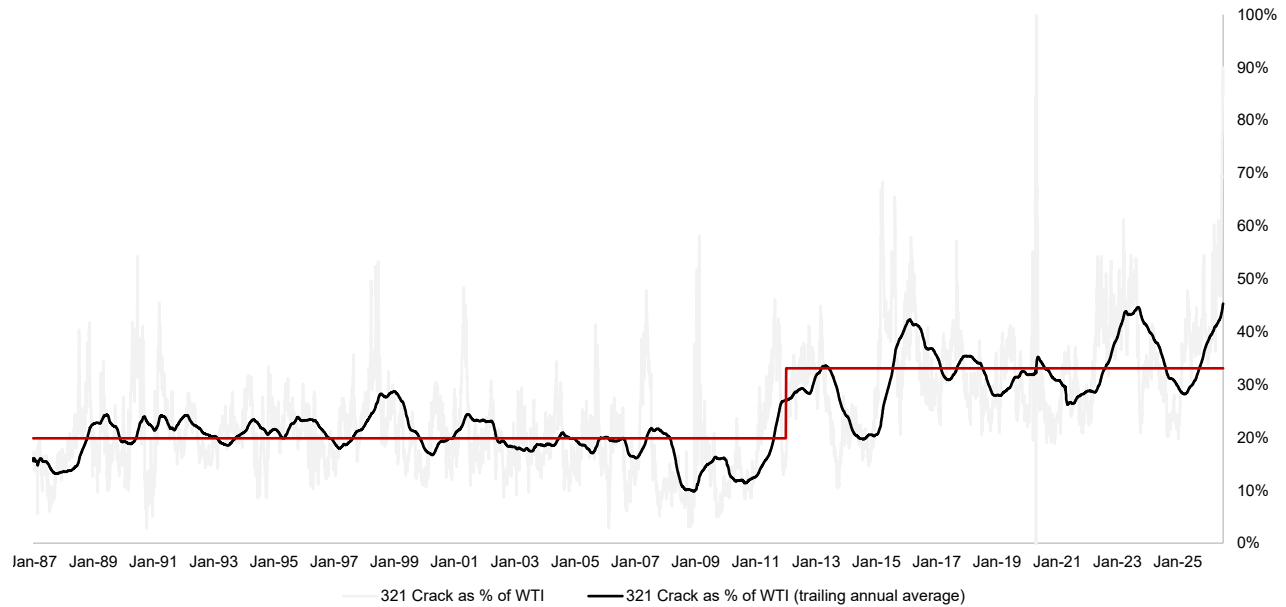
EXHIBIT 1: Oil price and crack spreads over time



Source: Bloomberg; Bernstein analysis

Of course the value of the dollar changes over time. We could apply a CPI deflator to move the data from nominal to real, or alternatively let's consider ratios.

We show ratios below. If we arbitrarily pick the start of 2012 as a 'break', we find that the average crack spread before was 20% and the average after was 33%. Why 2012? It was around the time when supply fears began to be mitigated by shale growth. It was around the time of the Arab Spring. It was around the time of sustained \$100/bbl oil. It also makes the end of the bottom of crack spreads. In any case, moving the specific choice around doesn't change the fact that crack spreads have been roughly a third of oil price over the last decade or so.

EXHIBIT 2: **Pre-shale crack spreads were a fifth (20%) and post-shale crack spreads are a third (33%)**

Source: Bloomberg; Bernstein analysis

If crack spreads are defined as:

$$\text{Crack} = (2 \times \text{Gas} + 1 \times \text{Diesel} - 3 \times \text{Oil}) / 3$$

then we can $(\text{Crack} / \text{Oil}) = \text{a third}$, we can show easily:

$$\text{Oil} = (2 \times \text{Gas} + 1 \times \text{Diesel}) / 4$$

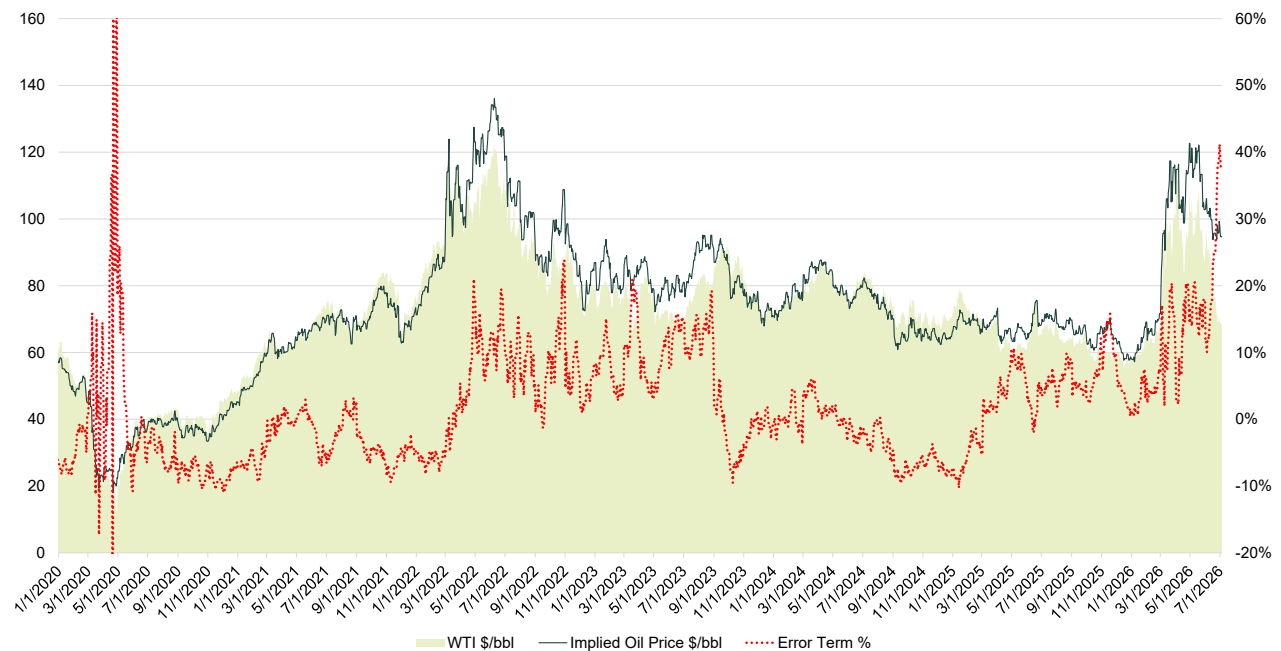
We can plot that formula against actual oil price. Note the fit is poor (under-predicts price) prior to 2012 but quite accurate afterwards.

EXHIBIT 3: **Back-solving for oil price from gasoline and diesel yields good fit**



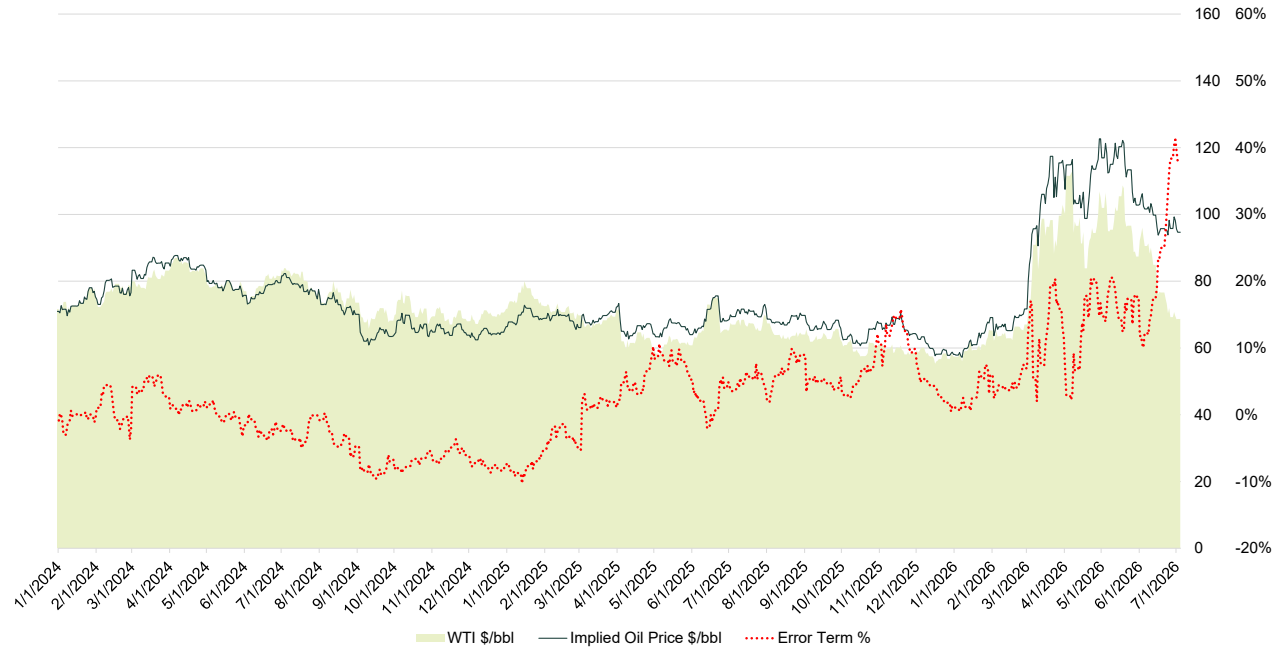
Source: Bloomberg; Bernstein analysis

EXHIBIT 4: **Post Covid-era...crack-implied oil price during Russia-Ukraine war was elevated ~10%...today's elevation is massive.**



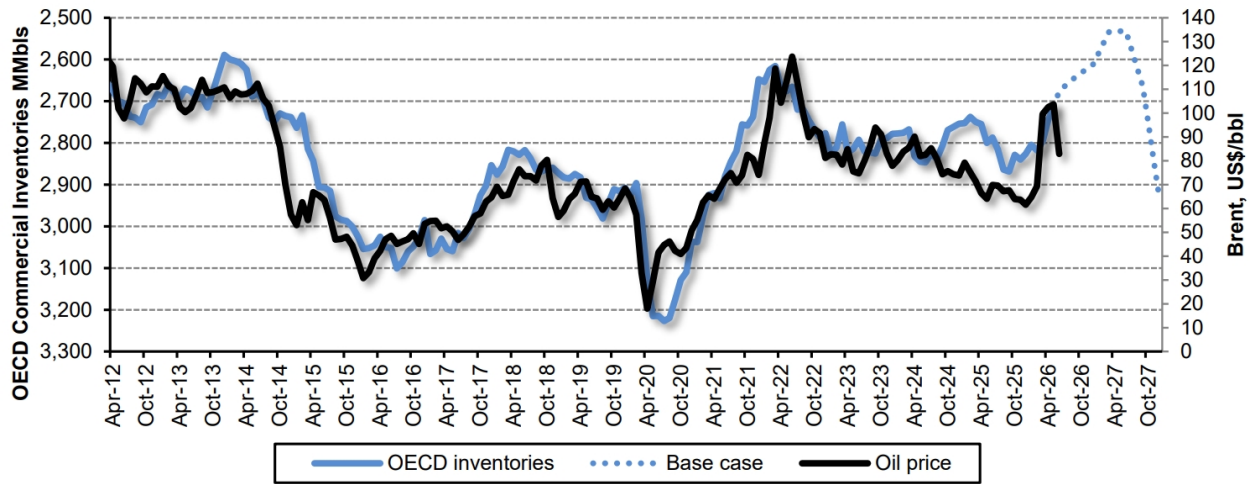
Source: Bloomberg; Bernstein analysis

EXHIBIT 5: Zooming in...crack-implied price today is >\$90/bbl



Source: Bloomberg; Bernstein analysis

EXHIBIT 6: Oil prices embed commercial (OECD in this case) inventories and seemingly ignore strategic (government) inventories such as SPRs



Source: IEA; EIA; Bloomberg; Bernstein analysis

BERNSTEIN TICKER TABLE

Ticker	Rating	Cur	6 Jul 2026	Price Target	TTM Rel. Perf.	Adjusted EPS				Adjusted P/E (x)		
			Closing Price			Cur	2025A	2026E	2027E	2025A	2026E	2027E
XOM (ExxonMobil)	O	USD	136.44	182.00	5.3%	USD	7.37	16.37	14.49	18.5	8.3	9.4
CVX (Chevron)	M	USD	168.10	204.00	(4.0)%	USD	8.43	16.58	13.26	19.9	10.1	12.7
COP (ConocoPhillips)	O	USD	103.58	121.00	(5.2)%	USD	6.18	13.89	10.88	16.8	7.5	9.5
DVN (Devon Energy)	O	USD	40.36	59.00	7.9%	USD	4.17	10.06	8.43	9.7	4.0	4.8
FANG (Diamondback)	O	USD	173.73	241.00	8.4%	USD	4.57	32.21	27.22	38.0	5.4	6.4
APA (APA)	M	USD	32.46	40.00	51.2%	USD	2.83	7.20	6.42	11.5	4.5	5.1
SPX			7,503.85									

O - Outperform, M - Market-Perform, U - Underperform, NR - Not Rated, CS - Coverage Suspended

Source: Bloomberg, Bernstein estimates and analysis.

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We rate XOM Outperform. We reach our target price of \$182/sh by applying an 7.0x multiple to 2027E EBITDA of \$96B and incorporating additional FCF to shareholders.

Chevron Corp

We rate CVX Market-Perform. We reach our target price of \$204/sh by applying a 6.5x multiple to 2027E EBITDA of \$59B and incorporating additional FCF to shareholders.

ConocoPhillips

We arrive at target price of \$121/sh by applying a 4.5x multiple to 2027E EBITDA of \$32B and incorporating additional FCF to shareholders.

Devon Energy Corp

We reach our target price of \$59/sh by applying a 3x EV multiple to 2027E EBITDA of \$10.6B and incorporating dividends to reflect total shareholder return.

Diamondback Energy, Inc.

We arrive at our target price of \$241/sh by applying a 4.5x multiple to 2027E adjusted EBITDA of \$15B and incorporating additional FCF to shareholders.

APA Corp

We reach our target price of \$40/sh by applying a 2.5x EV multiple to 2027E EBITDA of \$5.6B and incorporating dividends to reflect total shareholder return.

RISKS**Exxon Mobil Corp**

We rate XOM Outperform. Key downside risks to our price target include (a) market conditions yielding lower commodity prices than forecast, (b) failure to execute on critical growth initiatives (e.g. Stabroek, Permian, downstream/petrochemicals expansions), (c) lower refining margins than forecast, and (d) a prolonged polymer downcycle.

Chevron Corp

We rate CVX Market-Perform. Key downside risks to our price target include (a) market conditions yielding lower commodity prices than forecast, (b) failure to execute on critical growth initiatives (e.g. Permian, DJ, GoM, Tengiz), and (c) lower refining margins than

forecast.

ConocoPhillips

We rate COP Outperform. Key risks to our price target include (a) poor portfolio management, (b) lower commodity prices and (c) operational disruptions at COP's key facilities.

Devon Energy Corp

We rate DVN Outperform. Key downside risks to our price target include (a) lower commodity prices and differentials (especially Permian and NGLs) and (b) a poorly priced (or timed) acquisition or sale.

Diamondback Energy, Inc.

Key downside risks include (a) lower than expected commodity prices and differentials (e.g. Midland, Waha, NGLs), (b) the inability to meet stated cost synergy and production volume targets related to the pending acquisition of Endeavor Energy Resources, and (c) a poorly priced (or timed) acquisition or sale.

APA Corp

We rate APA Market-Perform. Key downside risks to our price target include (a) balance sheet risks in a low commodity environment, (b) execution mis-steps in Suriname, and (c) lower commodity prices. Key upside risks include (a) strong execution in Suriname and (b) higher commodity prices.

RATINGS DEFINITIONS, BENCHMARKS AND DISTRIBUTION

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Select Industry (SPSIINS) for US Non-Life Insurers coverage, and the Bloomberg Emerging Markets Financials Large, Mid and Small Cap Price Return Index (EMLSF) for emerging market banks and insurers and Payments. Ratings are stated relative to the sector (not the market).

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- Underperform (UP): Stock will trail the performance of the relevant index by more than 10 pp

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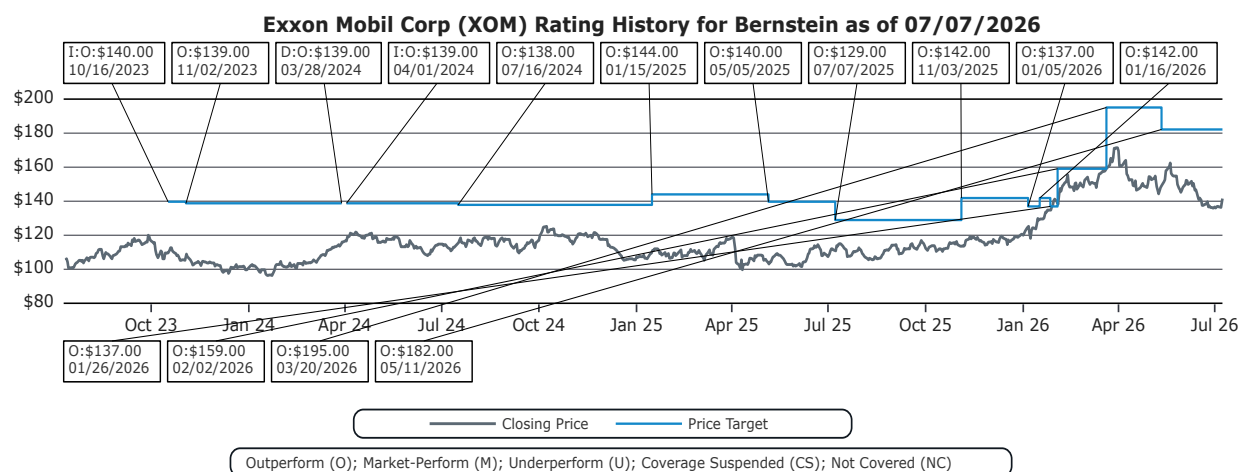
Equity Rating	Market Abuse Regulation (MAR) and FINRA Rating Category	Global Rating Distribution	Investment Banking Relationships*
Outperform	BUY	51.2%	15.3%
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Underperform	SELL	13.1%	13.6%

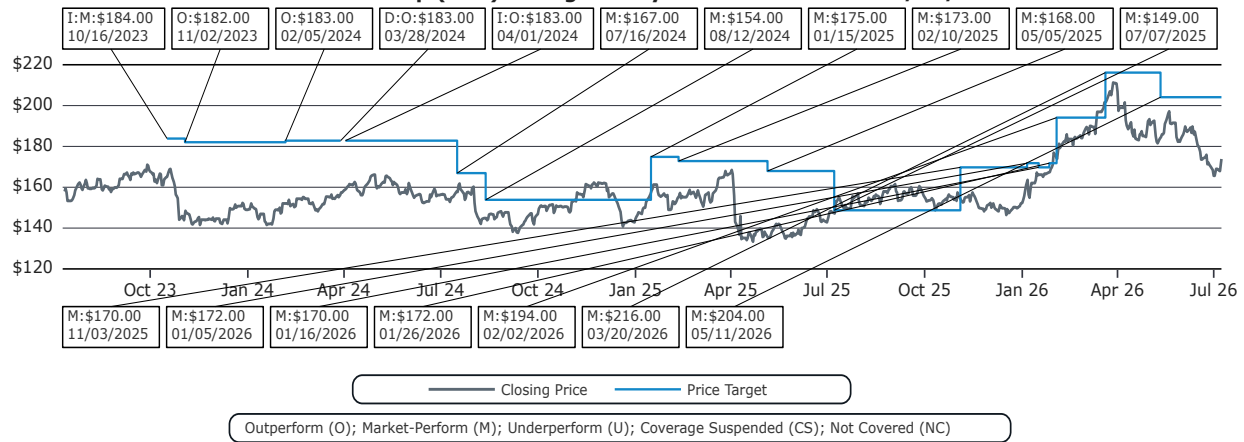
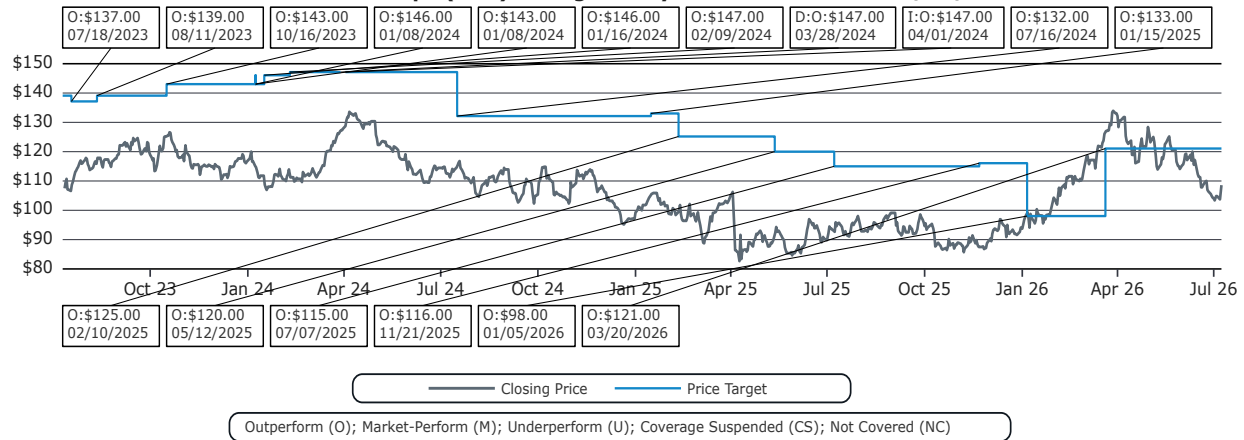
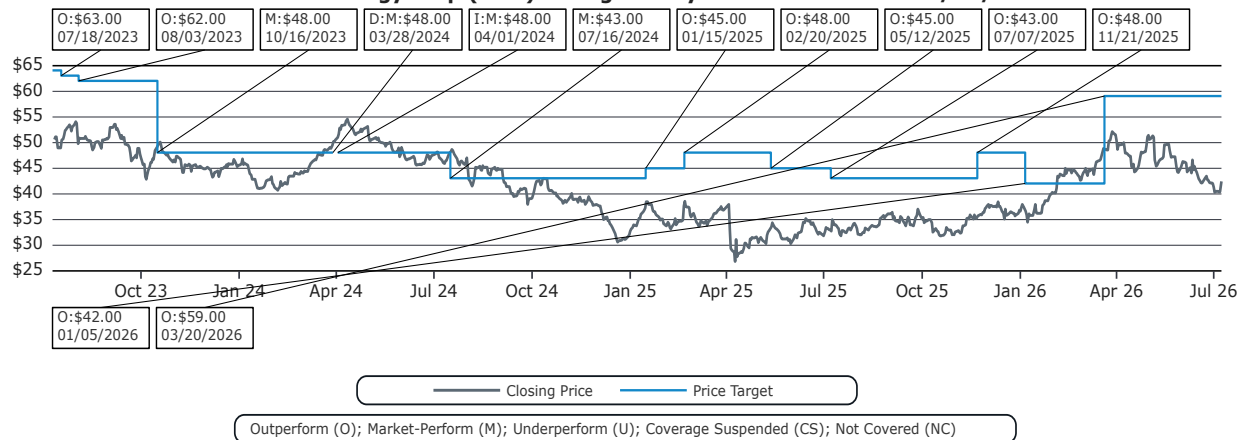
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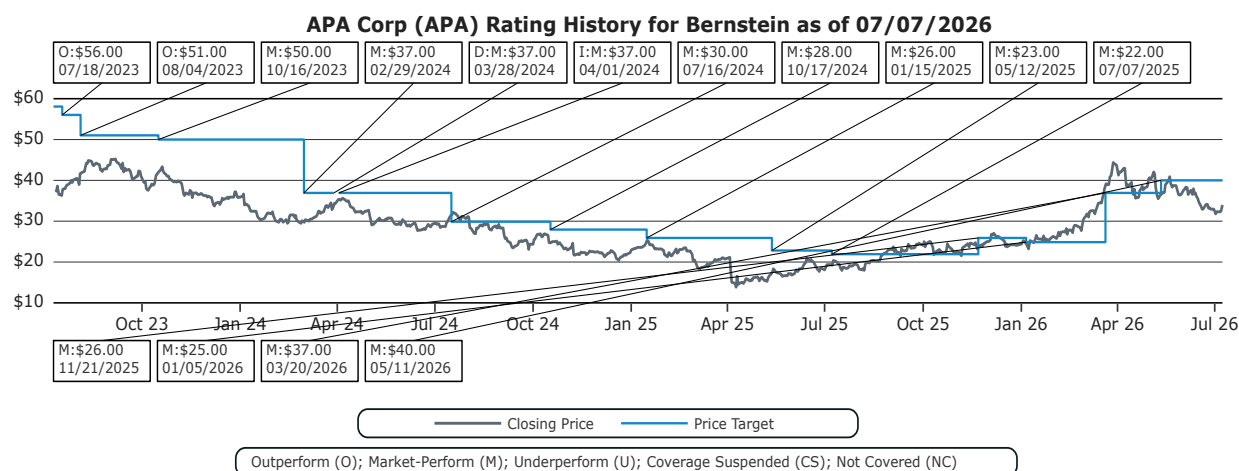
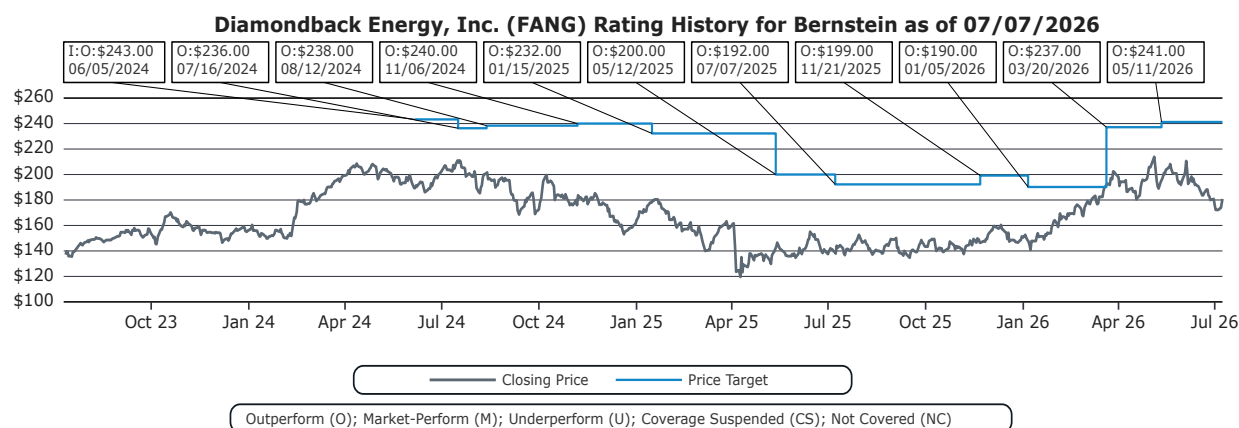
As of June 30, 2026. All figures are updated quarterly.

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